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From the Boston Atlas.

A Female Crusoe.

Off the coast of Alta California, about two degrees distant, bearing nearly west from Point San Pedro, which is in the latitude of $33^{\circ} 43' N.$, and longitude $118^{\circ} 14' W.$, will be found a small island, called by the Spaniards Saint Nicholas. This island was formerly inhabited by an inoffensive, indolent race of Indians, who subsisted almost entirely upon fish, which they caught from the rocks, and muscles, which they found in the sands of the beach. They were a listless, quiet race of beings, who seldom had communication with others of the human family, and who had but few wants and fewer cares.

About the year eighteen hundred and eighteen or twenty, the Russians, from their settlements at the North, landed on this island a party of Kodiak Indians, for the purpose of hunting the sea otter, which, at that period, abounded in those waters. This party remained on the island for more than two years; and were the means of sowing the seeds of disease and contention amongst its unsuspecting and unoppressed inhabitants.

Some ten or twelve years after the departure of the Kodiaks, this tribe had become diminished to about twenty or thirty individuals, when the governor of the department of California sent over a small vessel and removed them to the main.

In the last boat, which was embarking with the last of this people, (some six or eight perhaps in number,) to convey them to the vessel, which was to carry them from the home of their nativity forever, was one of the tribe, small in stature, not far advanced in years, and his dusky mate, then in the bloom of life. The order had been given to shove from the shore: the oars had dipped in the wave, the boat was rising on the foaming surf, then breaking on the beach with awful roar, when with the impulse of the moment as it were, this young and blooming bride of the red man, the imprint of whose footstep had been the last left on the sands of her island home, waived an

adieu to her chosen mate, plunged into the abyss, "strove through the surge," and in another moment, stood alone on the shores of her native land. She turned, to give the last lingering look to her departing helpmate; and then, gathering round her form her flowing mantle, was by the ocean wave, in an instant disappeared forever from the sight of her astonished and sorrowing companions.

The vessel weighed anchor, spread her canvass; and, in forty-eight hours, this remnant of the inhabitants of Saint Nicholas were landed on Point San Pedro, houseless and forlorn.

From that period to the present—if she be not dead, or has not left within the past eighteen months—has resided alone, on the isle of Saint Nicholas, this female Crusoe, the monarch of all she surveys. She preferred to part even with her chosen mate, and sever every human tie that could be binding, rather than leave the home of her birth—that lonely little isle, that had been to her a world, which she cared not to exchange for the abode of civilized man, with all its promised luxuries.

Since our Crusoe became the sole monarch of the isle, San Nicholas has been visited perhaps ten or twelve different times, by different individuals; but there she has continued to be found, with none to dispute her right—alone, solitary and forsaken.

Her dress, or covering, is composed of the skins of small birds, which she kills with stones, and sews them together with a needle of bone and the light sinews of the hair seal, sometimes found dead among the rocks. Her only food is a shell-fish, of the muscle species, with now and then a still smaller fish, which the surf sometimes throws on to the beach. She never remains long in one spot; but is constantly wandering around the shores of the island, sleeping, which she seldom does, in small caves and crevices in the rocks.

During the few last years, it has been very difficult to obtain any communication with her. At the approach of the white man she flees, as from an evil spirit; and the only way to detain her, is by running her down, as you would the wild goat of the mountain, or the young fawn of the plains.

Those who have seen her at the latest period, report that she appears to have lost all knowledge of language; that she makes only a wild noise, altogether inhuman; and, when taken and detained against her will, becomes frightened and restless; that the moment she is liberated, she darts off, and endeavours to secrete herself in the wild grass, or amongst the rocks which hang over the never ceasing surf.

Every endeavour has been made, and every inducement offered, by different individuals, to prevail upon her to leave the island, but in

vain. The only home she appears to desire, is her own little isle. Her last hope, if she has any, is, to finish her journey alone. She has no wish now, to hear again the sweet music of speech. Its sounds are no longer music to her ear—and, as for civilized man, his tameness is shocking even to her dormant senses.

To all appearance, she is strong, healthy, and content to be alone. What can reconcile her to her lot, who can conjecture? Humanity may hope that contentment may continue to be hers, to the last hour; for she is destined to lie down and die alone, on the cold shore of her isolated home, with no one to administer to her last wants, and none to cover her cold body, when the spirit shall have left the clay.

But the story of our Crusoe's chosen mate, the companion of her early life, has yet to be told. He saw her for the last time, as we have stated, when she stood alone on the shores of her own isle; when the boat with himself and his companions was dashing through the wild surf, that broke in uninterrupted succession against the rocks which encircled the resting-place of his fathers, and which he was then leaving forever. With the remnant of the family from San Nicholas, our hero was landed at San Pedro, and there left, with the others who had accompanied him, to find a home in that land of strangers.

San Pedro, it may be known, is a bleak, barren, bluff point, running out into the blue waters of the Pacific, on which no verdure is to be seen, and but one solitary abode of man, rising amidst the desolation which surrounds it. The Pueblo de Los Angeles is situated ten leagues distant, with one farm-house between the one on the point and those of the town. The mission of San Gabriel lies yet farther on, some three or four leagues; where, at that time, might be found perhaps three or four hundred converted Indians.

But our hero, as he may be called, never left the beach on which he was first landed. Alone and friendless, there he remained, an isolated being, till life ceased to animate his frame. True it is, that several times he was induced, and once or twice forced, to venture as far as the Pueblo, and even the mission of San Gabriel; but he always, as soon as at liberty, returned and resumed his old station on the beach, or fixed himself on the rocks which hung around the Point. And there he might always be seen, a solitary outcast, as it were, and more constantly when the sun was going down, with his eyes gazing on that celestial orb as it sunk into the western horizon, a direction which he well knew pointed to the lost but never forgotten home of his nativity.

With difficulty he sustained the wants of nature by fishing about the rocks, gathering muscles, and sometimes receiving a scanty pit-

tance of corn from the house on the Point, or a few pence from a passing stranger.

He studiously avoided, as far as possible, all intercourse with his fellow-men, and sought to live and die in solitude; and so did he continue to live a life which manifestly appeared a burden to him, till one morning, as the sun rose, not two years past, his body was found on the beach a stiffened corpse, stretched out, and bleaching, as it were, in the white foam of the surf, which was thrown about his lifeless remains as the mighty wave broke on the shore.

It is presumed his death was accidental—that whilst searching for shell-fish, in the night, amongst the cliffs, he must have fallen from an eminence, and thus terminated his solitary existence.

From the Presbyterian.

The Paulicians.

In A. D. 680, a man of the name of Constantine, who dwelt in Manalis, an obscure village in the neighbourhood of Samosata, in Syria, happened to entertain a deacon on his return from captivity among the Mohammedans, and received from him, as a present, a New Testament in the original language. Constantine, who it seems could read, (an acquirement becoming rather uncommon among the laity of those days) most earnestly applied himself to the study of the sacred volume, and formed a system of divinity from the divine oracles, especially from the epistles of Paul, different in many things from that Christianity, which was inculcated by the ignorant and superstitious priesthood. From his partiality to the inspired writings of Paul—a partiality which he likely communicated to his followers—most probably came the name of the sect of which he became the founder. The enemies of the Paulicians called them Manichees, and imputed to them some of the principles of that universally proscribed and detested heresy. But the imputation of such principles and practices, as expose those who are accused of them to general odium and persecution, has been made so often from hatred of the truth and of true piety, that it requires something more than the testimony of a few prejudiced and hostile witnesses to establish its justice. The Paulicians themselves disavowed the Manichean system; they held, as their enemies conceded, the orthodox doctrine of the Trinity; but they also condemned the image-worship which pervaded the East, were simply scriptural in the use of the sacraments, discarded relics, and all the fashionable equipage of superstition, held to the purity of the Christian ministry, and knew of no other Mediator than the Lord Jesus Christ.

Constantine, who assumed the name of Sylvanus, preached the gospel with great success, in Pontus and Cappadocia. He and his associates were distinguished from the clergy of that day, by their scriptural knowledge, zeal, and piety. Their churches were diffused over the provinces of Asia Minor; the Greek emperors became alarmed at the growing importance of the sect, and under Christian names and forms, re-acted the cruel persecutions of Galerius and Maximian. For one hundred and fifty years, with some intermissions, this storm

raged against them; and they were enabled to bear it with Christian meekness, and patience, while, as in other instances, the blood of the martyrs was the seed of the church. But, in a season of strong temptation; when, in A. D. 844, the empress Theodora, during the minority of her son, resolved to destroy the Paulicians, and had succeeded by hanging, beheading, drowning, and other forms of death, in cutting off about one hundred thousand of them, they seem to have been driven, by a sort of desperation, from the position they had so long, and so honourably occupied. Christian patience, and submission failed them; they retaliated their sufferings on some of the active creatures of the empress, sought and obtained an asylum among the Mohammedans; and, associated in arms with their Moslem allies, they were, for a time, a terror and scourge to the eastern provinces of the empire. That portion of the Paulicians which had recourse for protection, to carnal weapons, appears to have gradually lost both the spirit and the knowledge of Christianity. But there were other portions of the sect that, fleeing from the persecutions of the Greek emperors, penetrated into several of the countries of Europe, and noiselessly imparted the truth, as far as known to them, to others. Thus God was pleased to preserve, through long ages of defection, a seed to serve him, whose names unknown, or when known, calumniated among men, were enrolled in the Lamb's book of life.—Compare Mosheim, Cent. ix. p. ii. ch. 5, Cent. x. p. ii. ch. 5, Cent. xi. p. ii. ch. 5, Gibbon's Decline and Fall, vol. ii. ch. xv. Milner, Cent. ix. ch. ii. Jones, ch. iii. sect. 5.

Immigrants and Ship Fever.—It is said that the ship fever is prevailing to an alarming extent among the immigrants who are sheltered in the New York Alms House, and that in the present state of the buildings, it is scarcely possible to take effective remedial measures. The Courier and Inquirer suggests, and properly, that it would be well to erect a temporary hospital somewhere at the entrance to New York Harbour, where the immigrants might be taken care of until the effects of long confinement in the steerage of a ship shall be counteracted by fresh air and cleanliness. This seems the more desirable as there are said to be no such accommodations at the quarantine station as are made necessary by the great increase of immigrants. From the 1st to the 16th of last month there had arrived at New York 14,292 immigrants, or nearly 1000 daily; 162 died on the voyage; 242 have been admitted into the marine hospital, making the number now in that institution 300.—*Late Paper.*

Christians too often perform the difficult office of reproof in a very harsh and grating manner, forgetting that the reproof of the righteous should be like "excellent oil," not to break, but to heal the wounded spirit. Yet the harshness with which reproof may be given forms no excuse for a defect of Christian meekness and love in receiving it. "Be not hasty in thy spirit to be angry," but remember that "a soft answer turneth away wrath."

A New Fuel.—The English Builder states that the practical utility of chalk, as an article of fuel, has been tested, and with the most satisfactory results. Surrounded with coal, it gives a strong heat, and a clear fire, at half the usual expense; so that to the poor in the chalk districts it must be an invaluable boon.

—*Late Paper.*

The Fair Side.—When one was speaking ill of another in the presence of Peter the Great, he at first listened with much attention, and then interrupted him, saying, "Is there not a fair side also to the character of the person you are speaking of? Come, tell me his good qualities."

We have need of watchfulness in every circumstance in life. When we are alone we have our thoughts to watch; in the family our temper; in company our tongues.

Books.—When we are about to expend money for a book, it is well to recollect, that it is not for ourselves only. We know not into whose hands it may fall, or what encouragement we are giving to the dissemination of good or evil by the purchase. While we should scrupulously guard against encouraging the multiplication of pernicious books, it may be well to reflect upon the good we may do, by applying a proper portion of our means to increase the production and spread of useful works, especially such as speak well of the Redeemer's kingdom.—*Extract.*

The School of Christ.—People may, by industry and natural abilities make themselves masters of the external evidences of Christianity, and have much to say for and against different schemes and systems of sentiments; and all this, while the heart remains untouched. True religion is not a science of the head, but an inward heart-felt perception, which casts down imaginations, and everything that exalteth itself in the mind, and brings every thought into a sweet and willing subjection to Christ by faith. Here the *learned* have no real advantage above the ignorant; both see when the eyes of the understanding are enlightened; till then both are equally blind. And the first lesson in the school of Christ, is to become a little child, sitting simply at his feet, that we may be wise unto salvation.—*Ibid.*

The natural man loveth eloquence, and many love to hear eloquent orations; and if there is not a careful attention to the gift, men who have once laboured in the pure gospel ministry, growing weary of suffering, and ashamed of appearing weak, may kindle a fire, compass themselves about with sparks and walk in the light, not of Christ who is under suffering, but of that fire, which they going from the gift have kindled. And that in the hearers which is gone from the meek suffering state into the worldly wisdom, may be warmed with this fire, and speak highly of these labours. That which is of God gathers to God; and that which is of the world is owned by the world.—*John Woolman's Journal.*

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